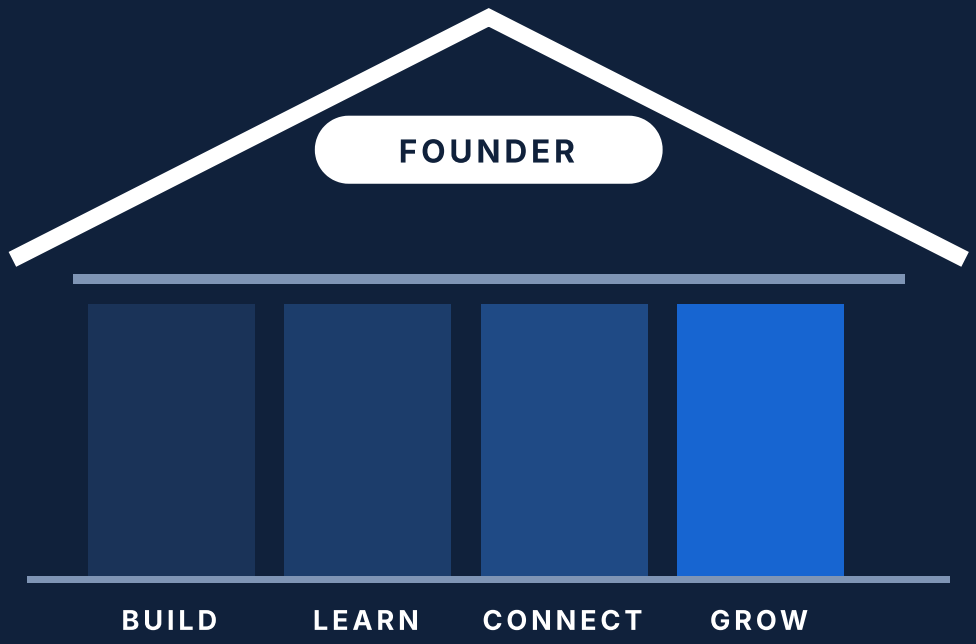
STARTUP ROOF



A FOUNDER ECOSYSTEM · UAE FIRST, GLOBAL AMBITION

STARTUP ROOF

A year-round ecosystem to help founders build, learn, connect and grow.

Home of Founder OS — the digital workspace for the founder journey.

startuproof.com

AT A GLANCE

A practical ecosystem around the founder — on one page.

Startup Roof brings practical guidance, useful tools and meaningful connections together to help founders take their next step.

Startup Roof is the ecosystem. **Founder OS** is the digital workspace inside it.

WHAT

A year-round founder ecosystem

Community, programmes, services and a guided digital workspace.

FOR WHOM

Founders first

Aspiring, early-stage and growing founders — tech and non-tech.

HOW

Build · Learn · Connect · Grow

Next steps, practical learning, relevant people and opportunities.

WHERE

UAE first, global ambition

Starting in the UAE and widening coverage over time.

STAGE

Shaping and pilot phase

Testing the founder experience with an initial group of contributors.

NEXT

A small, measured pilot

Useful sessions, onboarding and follow-up — then expand what works.

CONTENTS

01 **Why founders need a roof** — context and evidence

02 **The concept** — ecosystem, pillars, audiences, sectors

03 **The founder journey** — stages, checklists, metrics, funding

04 **Founder OS** — the planned digital workspace

05 **Ecosystem services** — community, mentoring, Academy, experts

06 **Value for the ecosystem** — investors and partners

07 **Model, pilot and roadmap** — economics, measures, risks

08 **People and participation** — contribute, FAQ, glossary

WHY STARTUP ROOF

Founders need more than information. They need a practical path forward.

Starting a business has never had more advice available — and it can still feel hard to know what to do next. Startup Roof is being developed to connect practical guidance, useful tools and the right people around a founder, so each step forward is clearer.

WHAT FOUNDERS OFTEN FACE

01 Information is scattered

Guidance sits across many websites, groups and programmes.

02 Tools do not connect

Plans, tasks and contacts live in separate apps.

03 Advice lacks a next step

General advice rarely becomes “what do I do this week?”

04 The right people are hard to find

Mentors and specialists are reached by chance, not fit.

05 Introductions go nowhere

Few connections lead to a conversation with a useful outcome.

06 Time and money are limited

Every hour and every dirham has to count.

OUR PURPOSE

Startup Roof brings practical guidance, useful tools and meaningful connections together to help founders take their next step.

These challenges are our starting hypotheses. We are testing them directly with founders through interviews, sessions and follow-up before scaling anything.

FOUR THINGS FOUNDERS NEED

Build | Learn | Connect | Grow

> **An ecosystem around the founder.**
> **A digital workspace for the journey.**

HOW WE APPROACH IT

Practical by design

Every session, resource and introduction should end with a clear next step for the founder.

Open to many sectors

Technology startups and commercially viable consumer, wellness, retail and service businesses.

Tested before scaled

Currently shaping the platform and testing the founder experience through an initial collaboration and pilot phase.

WHY STARTUPS STRUGGLE

Most failures come back to the market, cash and competition.

International evidence is consistent: many new businesses close within a few years, and the reasons are often avoidable with earlier validation, financial discipline and good advice.

Top reasons startups fail

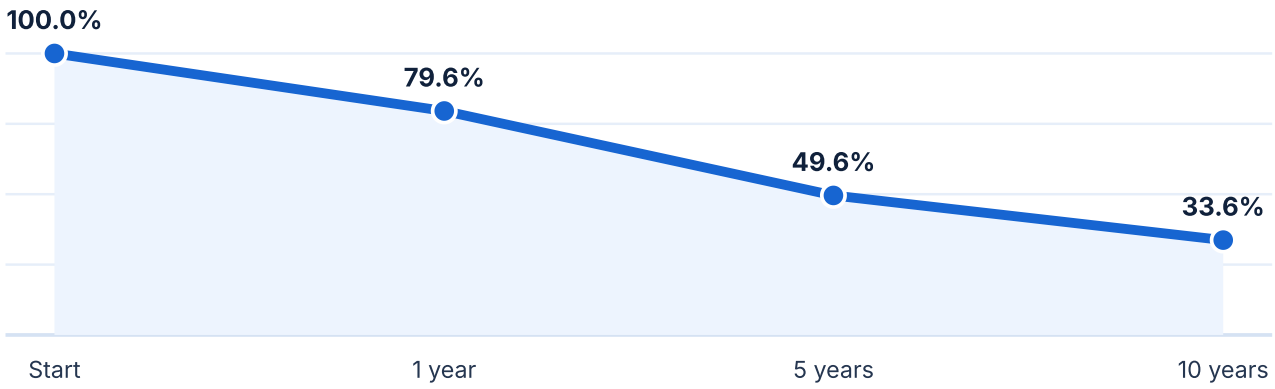
% of 111 startup post-mortems citing each reason (multiple reasons allowed).



Source: CB Insights, "The Top 12 Reasons Startups Fail", 2021.

How many businesses survive

Share of US private-sector establishments opened in March 1994 still operating.



34.7%
of US establishments born in 2013 were still operating in 2023.

≈ 50%
of start-ups survive five years across OECD countries studied.

1 in 2
Support in the early years matters.

Sources: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Business Employment Dynamics; BLS "The Economics Daily" (2024); Calvino, Criscuolo & Menon, OECD (2015).

EVIDENCE THAT SUPPORT HELPS

Mentors, networks and structure are linked to better outcomes.

33%

of New York tech founders mentored by successful entrepreneurs became top performers — over three times the rate of other firms.

Endeavor Insight, 2015

2×

Companies connected to a top-performing company were twice as likely to become top performers.

Endeavor Insight

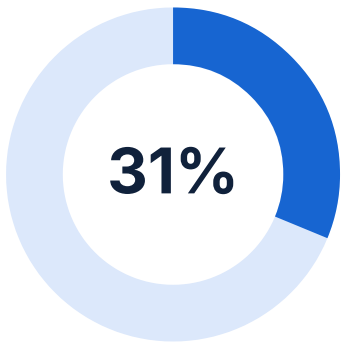
47–171%

more funding raised by accelerator companies than near-miss peers in three of four cohorts studied.

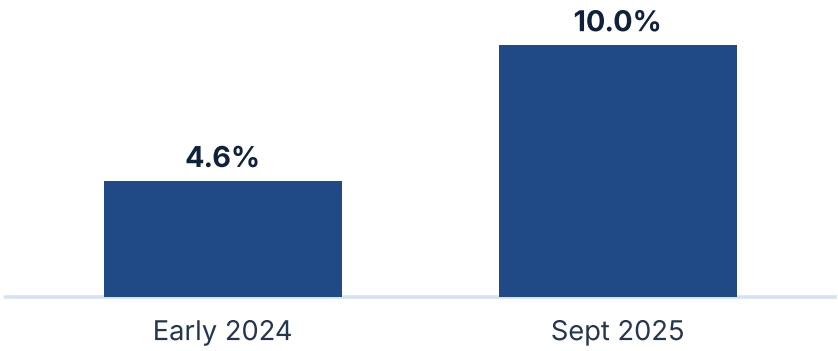
Hallen, Cohen & Bingham, 2020

These studies show associations, not guarantees. They support Startup Roof's design choice: combine mentoring, peer networks and structured programmes — then measure outcomes.

AI is arriving in small businesses



of SMEs surveyed in seven OECD countries use generative AI (late 2024).



US firms using AI to produce goods or services — roughly doubling in under two years.

What this means for Startup Roof

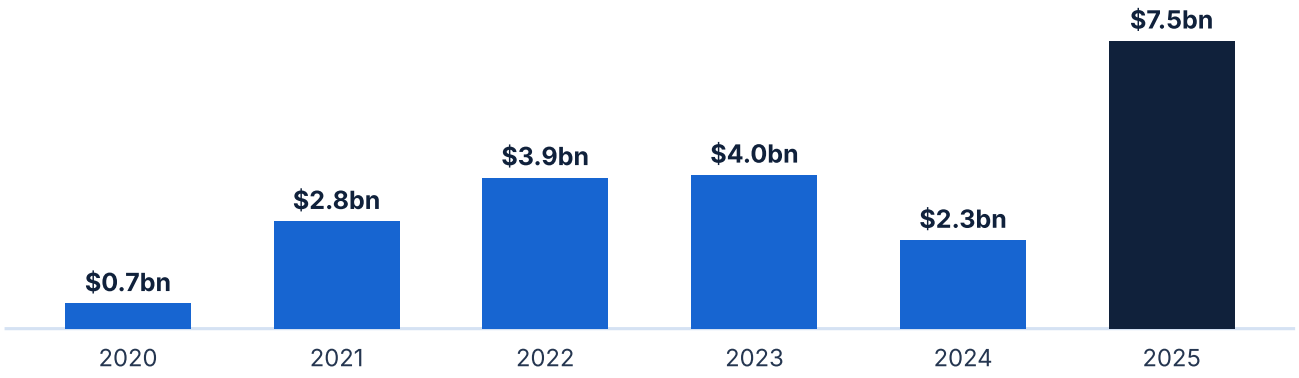
Practical AI and automation is a Founder Academy theme, and Founder OS plans AI-assisted guidance — always with human support for important decisions.

Sources: OECD, "Generative AI and the SME Workforce" (2025); US Census Bureau, Business Trends and Outlook Survey.

A national ambition to become a home for entrepreneurs.

MENA startup funding reached a record in 2025

Total startup funding raised in MENA, US$ billions (includes debt financing).



Source: Wamda annual MENA investment reviews, 2020–2025. 2023 includes $1.77bn of debt.

#1
globally in the GEM National Entrepreneurship Context Index, five years running.
GEM 2025/2026

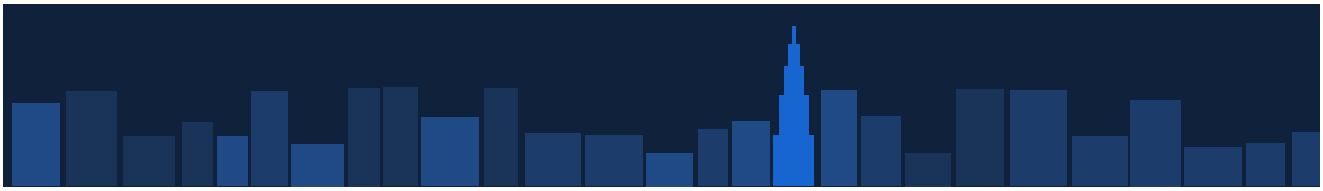
63.5%
of non-oil GDP from SMEs, which are 94.4% of UAE companies.
UAE Ministry of Economy / Central Bank

557k → 1m
SMEs at end-2022, with a target of one million by 2030.
UAE Minister of Economy

30
companies to grow into global unicorns under Dubai's D33 agenda.
Dubai Economic Agenda D33

$1.1bn
raised by UAE startups across 207 deals in 2024, first in MENA.
Wamda 2024 review

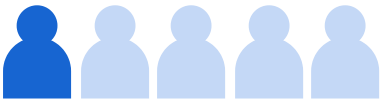
#19
Dubai's rank among global emerging startup ecosystems.
Startup Genome GSER 2025



UAE FOUNDERS TODAY

High ambition, real opportunity — and a fear of failure to address.

The Global Entrepreneurship Monitor's survey of UAE adults shows strong entrepreneurial intent. It also shows why practical support and small first steps matter.



1 in 5

adults in the UAE were starting or running a new business in 2025 — up from about one in seven in 2024.



9 in 10

adults see good opportunities to start a business — among the highest of all economies surveyed.



Over half

of those who see opportunities say fear of failure would stop them starting.

Our response

Structured validation, peer groups, mentors and small, low-risk first steps make starting less daunting — and help more good ideas get tested properly.

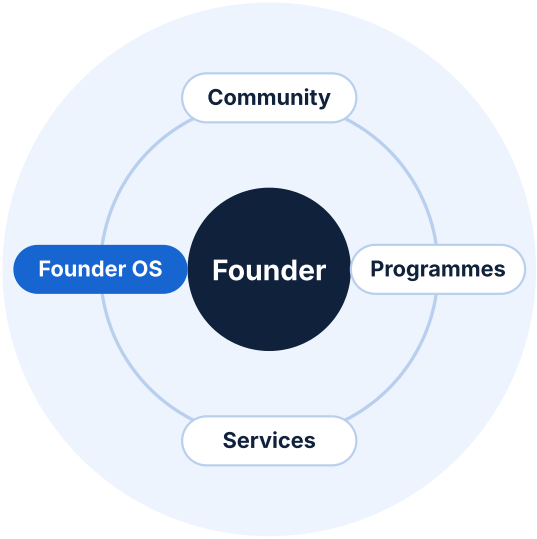
Closing a gap

Female-founded startups received 1.2% of MENA startup funding in 2024 (Wamda). Inclusive community, mentoring and readiness support are part of the design.

Sources: Global Entrepreneurship Monitor, UAE country profile (2025); Wamda 2024 MENA review.

THE ECOSYSTEM MODEL

One ecosystem around the founder.



STARTUP ROOF = the wider ecosystem

The community, programmes, relationships and services around a founder all year — online and in person.

FOUNDER OS = the digital workspace

The guided online experience inside the ecosystem: a founder's profile, goals, next steps, resources and connections in one place.

Startup Roof begins with a UAE focus and has a global ambition. It is designed for technology startups *and* commercially viable businesses in sectors such as consumer products, wellness, retail and services. Not every business needs venture funding, and many grow from their own revenue.

WHO IT IS FOR — AND WHY THEY TAKE PART

AUDIENCE	WHAT THEY GAIN
Aspiring entrepreneurs	A clear place to test an idea and understand where to start.
Early-stage founders	Validation, structure, feedback and help reaching first customers.
Founders seeking growth	Operational support, specialists and sharper go-to-market.
Mentors and specialists	A structured way to share experience with founders who fit their expertise.
Investors and angels	Engagement with better-prepared founders in sectors of interest.
Universities and incubators	Continued support for student and alumni founders beyond one programme.
Corporate innovation teams	Contact with early ventures through practical challenges and pilots.
Technology and service providers	A relevant route to founders who need their tools and services.

BUILD · LEARN · CONNECT · GROW

Four things founders need, under one roof.



BUILD	LEARN	CONNECT	GROW
Turn an idea into a working business. Next-step plans, templates, product and setup guidance. IN FOUNDER OS **Tasks and templates**	**Gain practical skills, quickly.** Founder Academy sessions that end in an action. IN FOUNDER OS **Learning progress**	**Reach the right people.** Consent-based introductions, mentors, peers and specialists. IN FOUNDER OS **Discovery and requests**	**Find customers, capability and capital.** Go-to-market, expert services, readiness and opportunities. IN FOUNDER OS **Opportunities and progress**

Sectors we serve — not only tech

SECTOR	EXAMPLES	TYPICAL CHALLENGES
Technology	Software, platforms, AI-enabled products	Product–market fit, technical cost, recurring revenue, investor readiness
Consumer products	Food, beauty, home and lifestyle brands	Margin, sourcing and manufacturing, retail and e-commerce channels, brand
Wellness	Fitness, nutrition, wellbeing, care	Trust, licensing and compliance, repeat customers, community
Retail	Physical and online stores, marketplaces	Inventory and cash flow, channel mix, acquisition cost, operations
Services	Agencies, consultancies, B2B and local services	Pricing and packaging, productising expertise, pipeline, hiring

Venture funding is one route, not the goal. Many strong businesses grow from revenue — Startup Roof is designed for them too.

ILLUSTRATIVE PERSONAS

Four example founders, four different next steps.



The aspiring founder

EXPLORE

SITUATION

Has an idea and a full-time job; unsure where to start.

WHAT THEY NEED

Clarity on whether the idea is worth testing.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Validation guide, peer group, first clinic.



The first-time brand owner

VALIDATE → BUILD

SITUATION

Launching a consumer product with savings.

WHAT THEY NEED

Evidence that customers will buy at a viable margin.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Pricing session, sourcing specialist, retail mentor.



The tech founder

LAUNCH

SITUATION

Has a product and early users; needs traction.

WHAT THEY NEED

A repeatable way to acquire paying customers.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

GTM sprint, customer-acquisition mentor, tool credits.



The growing service business

GROW

SITUATION

Profitable agency, stuck at founder capacity.

WHAT THEY NEED

Systems, hiring and productised offers.

HOW STARTUP ROOF HELPS

Operations specialist, automation, peer group.

Personas are illustrative composites used for design — not real people.

How value flows

PARTICIPANT	GIVES	GETS
Mentors and specialists	Experience and judgement	Purposeful impact, visibility, good-fit founders
Investors and angels	Readiness feedback, sessions	Better-prepared founders
Universities and incubators	Talent, programmes, research	Continuity for student founders
Corporates	Challenges, pilots, expertise	Early innovation and partners
Service and tool providers	Services, tools, offers	Relevant founder customers
Founder community	Peer advice and accountability	Support, network, momentum

Every founder starts somewhere different.

Founders join at different stages and follow different paths. The journey below is a guide, not a fixed sequence.

STAGE	COMMON FOUNDER QUESTION	USEFUL NEXT ACTION
Explore	Is this idea worth pursuing?	Write down the problem and who has it.
Validate	Will people actually pay for this?	Speak to 10–20 potential customers.
Build	What is the simplest version to offer?	Define a first offer and test it.
Launch	How do I reach my first customers?	Run one focused acquisition test.
Grow	How do I grow without breaking things?	Fix the biggest operational bottleneck.
Prepare for capital	Should I raise — and am I ready?	Decide whether external funding fits. Only where appropriate.

Founder OS: the digital workspace

PLANNED CAPABILITY

1 My startup

Founder profile, stage and goals, personal dashboard.

2 Next steps

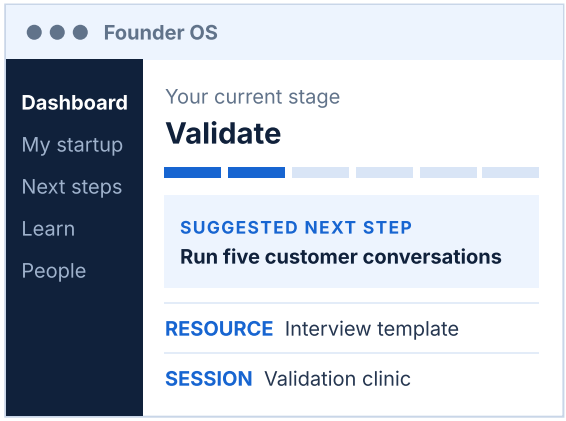
Tasks, resources and templates, learning progress.

3 People and support

Mentor and specialist discovery, connection and service requests.

4 Opportunities and progress

Relevant opportunities, activity and progress tracking.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

THE FOUNDER JOURNEY IN PRACTICE

From idea to a first offer.

STAGE 1 Explore

Decide whether an idea is worth testing.

KEY QUESTIONS

Whose problem is this, and how painful is it?

How do people solve it today?

Why am I the right person to solve it?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Write a one-line problem statement
- ☐ Describe the target customer
- ☐ List current alternatives
- ☐ Note your unfair advantages
- ☐ Pick three assumptions to test

Sign of progress: A clear, testable problem statement · **Startup Roof support:** Peer groups, idea clinics, Explore templates

STAGE 2 Validate

Prove that people want it — and will pay.

KEY QUESTIONS

Will people pay, and how much?

Who is the first, most eager customer?

What is the smallest test I can run?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Run 10–20 customer conversations
- ☐ Test a price with a pre-order or deposit
- ☐ Build a landing page or sample
- ☐ Record what you learned
- ☐ Decide: continue, change or stop

Sign of progress: Customers committing time or money · **Startup Roof support:** Validation clinic, interview guide, mentor feedback

STAGE 3 Build

Create the simplest version people will pay for.

KEY QUESTIONS

What is the minimum viable product?

Which company structure and licence do I need?

What will it cost to deliver?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Define the first offer and scope
- ☐ Choose setup route and licence
- ☐ Estimate unit costs and margin
- ☐ Set up basic finance and contracts
- ☐ Line up first customers

Sign of progress: A first offer delivered to real customers · **Startup Roof support:** Setup, legal and product specialists; templates

From first customers to scale — and capital where it fits.

STAGE 4 Launch

Reach first customers in a repeatable way.

KEY QUESTIONS

Which channel brings customers most efficiently?

Is my pricing right?

What do customers say after buying?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Pick one acquisition channel to test
- ☐ Track cost per customer
- ☐ Collect reviews and feedback
- ☐ Refine pricing and packaging
- ☐ Build a simple sales process

Sign of progress: Repeat sales from a known channel · **Startup Roof support:** GTM sessions, marketing and sales specialists

STAGE 5 Grow

Scale what works without breaking the business.

KEY QUESTIONS

Where is the biggest bottleneck?

Which roles or systems come next?

How do I protect cash while growing?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Map the operating bottleneck
- ☐ Automate repeat tasks
- ☐ Plan first key hires
- ☐ Review margins by product or client
- ☐ Set a 12-month cash plan

Sign of progress: Growth with healthy margins and cash · **Startup Roof support:** Operations, automation, finance and hiring support

STAGE 6 Prepare for capital

Decide if external funding fits — and get ready.

KEY QUESTIONS

Do I need outside money, and why?

Which type of capital suits my business?

What will investors ask to see?

PRACTICAL CHECKLIST

- ☐ Define what the money is for
- ☐ Compare funding options
- ☐ Prepare core metrics and a data room
- ☐ Sharpen the pitch and story
- ☐ Practise with experienced investors

Sign of progress: A funding decision made on evidence · **Startup Roof support:** Readiness review, pitch feedback, relevant introductions

The numbers every founder should understand.

MVP
Minimum viable product
The simplest version customers will use or pay for.

PMF
Product–market fit
Customers keep buying and recommending.

CAC
Customer acquisition cost
Sales + marketing spend ÷ new customers.

LTV
Customer lifetime value
Gross profit per customer over time.

GM
Gross margin
(Revenue − direct costs) ÷ revenue.

Burn
Monthly net burn
Cash out − cash in, per month.

Runway
Months of cash left
Cash ÷ monthly net burn.

Churn
Customer churn
Customers lost ÷ customers at start.

Rule of thumb many investors use: LTV should comfortably exceed CAC — often cited as about 3×. It varies by sector and model.

There is more than one way to fund a business

SOURCE	BEST SUITED TO	YOU GIVE UP	WATCH OUT FOR
Revenue and savings	Businesses that can sell early	Nothing — full control	Slower growth; personal risk
Friends and family	Very early tests	Sometimes equity	Relationships if it goes wrong
Grants and programmes	Innovation, sector or social goals	Time and reporting	Eligibility and timelines
Bank and SME finance	Proven revenue and assets	Repayments, collateral	Cash-flow pressure
Angel investors	Early teams with potential to scale	Equity	Fit, terms, expectations
Venture capital	Fast-growing, large-market ventures	Equity and some control	Pressure for rapid scale
Venture debt	VC-backed companies with revenue	Repayments, covenants	Usually needs equity first
Crowdfunding	Consumer products with a community	Rewards or equity	Campaign effort; scrutiny

General guidance only — not financial advice.

CAPITAL, WHERE IT FITS

How equity funding stages usually work.

Bootstrapped

USED TO
Own money and revenue

INVESTORS LOOK FOR
A real problem and early demand

Pre-seed

USED TO
Test and build the first version

INVESTORS LOOK FOR
Team, insight and first signals

Seed

USED TO
Find product–market fit

INVESTORS LOOK FOR
Early traction and repeat usage

Series A

USED TO
Build a repeatable growth engine

INVESTORS LOOK FOR
Proven model and strong metrics

Growth

USED TO
Scale into new markets

INVESTORS LOOK FOR
Efficient, predictable growth

Stage names and expectations vary by market and sector. Many businesses never raise equity — and that can be the right choice.

Investor readiness checklist

BUSINESS	MODEL	TEAM	FINANCE	LEGAL
☐ A clear problem and target customer	☐ Unit economics you understand	☐ The right founding team, gaps known	☐ Up-to-date accounts and runway	☐ Clean company and share structure
☐ Evidence of demand or traction	☐ A credible plan for the funds	☐ Advisers or mentors where useful	☐ A simple financial model	☐ IP and key contracts in order

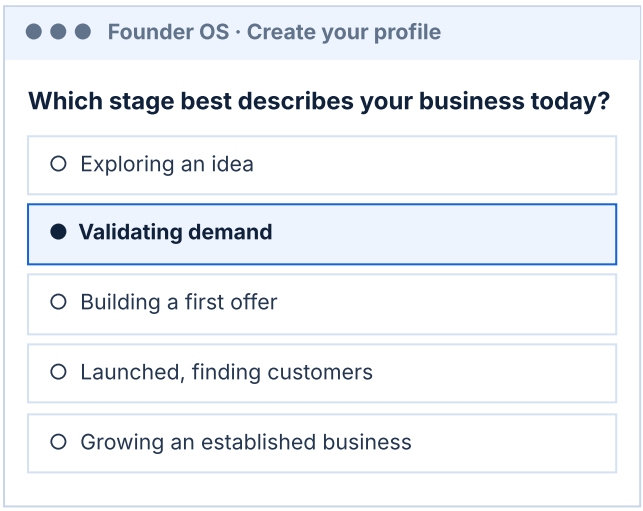
How Startup Roof helps: readiness reviews, pitch feedback, data-room templates and — where relevant and with consent — introductions to investors who match the founder's sector and stage.

PLANNED CAPABILITY

What founders will see — and why it helps.

Onboarding

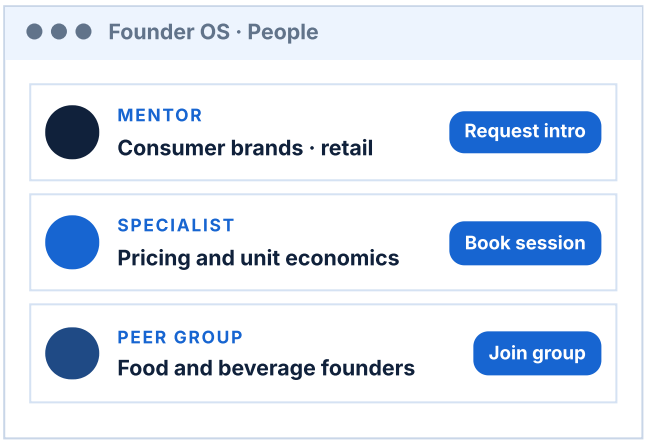
A five-minute profile — stage, sector, goals, support needs and visibility settings — shapes everything after it.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

People

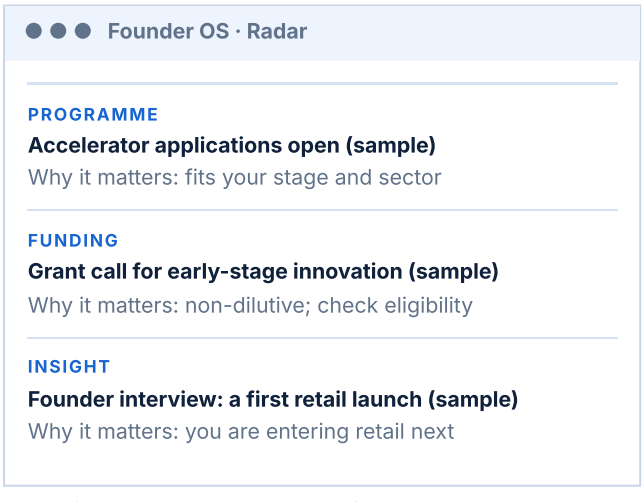
A few well-matched mentors, specialists and peers — by need, stage, sector and availability. Consent on both sides.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

Opportunities (Radar)

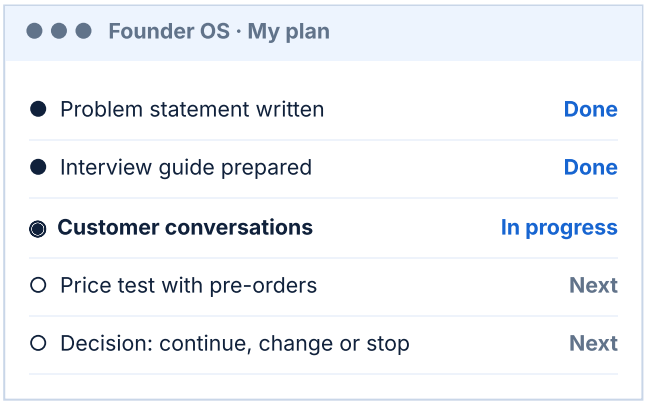
Relevant programmes, funding calls, events and insights — each dated, credited and with a next step.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

My plan

Stage templates founders adapt. Completed steps are how we measure whether support is useful.



Illustrative product concept — not a live screen.

PLANNED CAPABILITY

The next-step engine, the building blocks and the principles.

INPUTS

Profile and sector

Current stage

90-day goals

Recent progress

Time and budget

→

GUIDANCE

Stage playbooks

Rules from mentors

AI-assisted suggestions

Human review for complex cases

→

OUTPUTS

One clear next step

A relevant resource

A session to join

A person to meet

An opportunity

↻ **Progress recorded → the next suggestion improves**

Planned building blocks

Experience	Web and mobile-friendly workspace · dashboard · notifications · community spaces
Founder modules	Profile · next steps · resources · learning · people · opportunities · services · progress
Guidance layer	Stage playbooks · mentor rules · AI-assisted drafting and suggestions · human escalation
Data and trust	Consent records · visibility settings · secure storage · audit of introductions
Integrations	Calendar and video · email and messaging · payments · partner tools, where rights allow

Trust, privacy and responsible AI

Consent first
No introduction or data sharing without agreement.

Founder-controlled visibility
Founders decide what is shown, and to whom.

Data minimisation
Collect only what improves support.

Transparent AI
AI content labelled; a person is always available.

Human escalation
Complex matters go to qualified people.

Secure by design
Access controls, encryption, audit trails.

Designed with the UAE Personal Data Protection Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 45 of 2021) in mind; formal legal review will precede launch.

Start small, learn fast, then add depth.

The first version should be small enough to test quickly. The pilot can begin with simple tools behind the scenes — the point is to learn what founders actually use.

MUST HAVE Pilot	SHOULD HAVE After pilot	COULD HAVE Once proven	LATER Separate decisions
Founder profile and stage	Mentor and specialist discovery	AI-assisted drafting and planning	Investor-readiness profiles
Next-step suggestions	Opportunities feed (Radar)	Partner tool integrations	Payments and marketplace
Resource and template library	Peer groups and discussions	Learning paths with progress	Multi-market localisation
Session booking and requests	Service request workflow	Mobile app experience	Advanced analytics
Basic progress tracking			

Service requests — from need to reviewed outcome

Request	Scope	Match	Agree	Deliver	Review

Clear scope first
No open-ended engagements.

Transparent pricing
Agreed before any work starts.

Vetted providers
Selected on track record and fit.

Founder reviews
Quality visible over time.

Safeguards and prioritisation will be confirmed with pilot founders.

PROPOSED APPROACH

Digital guidance, strengthened by human experience.

AI can help founders organise their thinking and keep momentum. People bring judgement, sector experience and accountability. Startup Roof is designed to combine both — and to leave decisions with the founder.

AI-ASSISTED SUPPORT	HUMAN SUPPORT
Organising information	Mentoring
Helping founders explore questions	Specialist judgement
Drafting plans	Practical feedback
Suggesting resources	Complex business decisions
Tracking next steps	Sector expertise

> **AI prepares, people judge, founders decide.** AI features will be tested with pilot founders before release; none is described here as live.

How the experience is designed to work

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

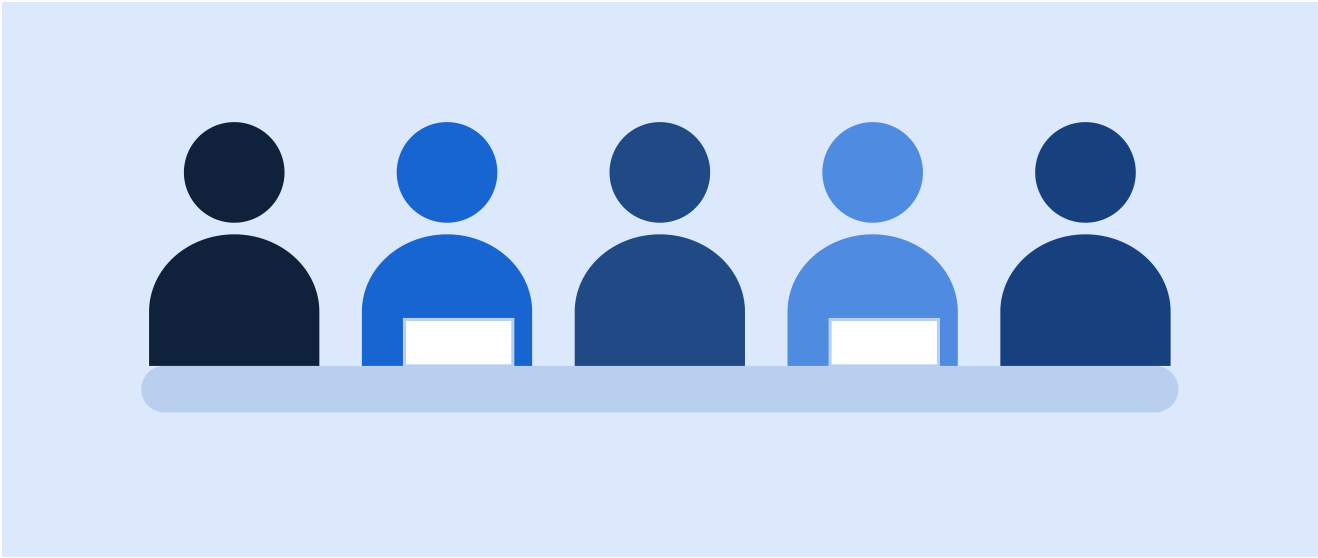
A first-time founder in Dubai wants to launch a healthy-snack brand. The recipe is ready, but there is no evidence yet that customers will buy.

1. **Complete a profile**
   Stage, sector, goals and time available.
2. **Identify the challenge**
   “I don’t know if anyone will pay for this.”
3. **Get a relevant next step**
   An interview guide and a short validation task.
4. **Attend a clinic or ask for help**
   A group validation clinic or a mentor request.
5. **Record progress**
   Notes from customer conversations and pricing feedback.
6. **Return for the next step**
   Move on to testing a first offer.

An example of the intended experience — not a real customer case.

PROPOSED

Support that does not stop when a programme ends.



RHYTHM	WHAT COULD HAPPEN
Weekly	Office hours · peer-group check-ins · new resources and opportunities in Founder OS
Monthly	Thematic clinics · Academy sessions · mentor rounds · small founder gatherings
Quarterly	Progress reviews · showcase sessions · partner workshops · cohort intakes
Always on	Founder OS workspace · community discussions · service requests · Radar insights

How mentoring works

1. **Prepare** — Founder states the question and context.
2. **Match** — A relevant mentor accepts.
3. **Meet** — 30–60 minutes on one decision.
4. **Commit** — One or two concrete actions.
5. **Follow up** — Progress check; next session if useful.

MENTORS COMMIT TO

- Honest, practical feedback
- Declaring conflicts of interest
- Respecting confidentiality
- Agreed availability

FOUNDERS COMMIT TO

- Preparing a clear question
- Respecting the mentor's time
- Acting on what was agreed
- Sharing progress and feedback

COMMUNITY, LEARNING AND EXPERT SUPPORT

Relevant people, practical learning and the right specialist.

Community and meaningful connections

Founder introductions, peer groups, office hours, mentor sessions, small gatherings, community discussions and accountability check-ins. We will judge success by completed, useful interactions — not directory size.

Request	Consent	Introduction	Conversation	Follow-up	Outcome noted

Product principles: consent from both sides before any introduction, and founder-controlled profile visibility.

Founder Academy

PROPOSED THEMES

Every session follows a simple loop: **Learn → Apply → Receive feedback → Take the next action.**

- Idea validation
- Business models
- AI and automation
- Go-to-market and customer acquisition
- Pricing and unit economics
- Pitch readiness
- Legal and operational foundations
- Consumer-brand and retail development

No course catalogue exists yet; sessions will be shaped with founders and contributors during the pilot.

Expert services and partner tools

Potential categories: legal · accounting and finance · branding and design · technology and automation · marketing and sales · customer communication · business setup · product and retail guidance.

Expert sessions

Clinics and one-to-one time with experienced practitioners.

Partner-provided services

Defined packages from vetted providers, scoped up front.

Integrated tools

Useful software inside Founder OS, or white-label, where commercial rights allow.

Packages, providers, integrations and fulfilment will be validated during the pilot. No supplier is presented as a confirmed partner.

PROPOSED

Learn it on Monday. Use it on Tuesday.

THEME	EXAMPLE SESSION	FOUNDER LEAVES WITH
Idea validation	Customer interviews that reveal the truth	An interview guide and 10 people to call
Business models	How your business actually makes money	A one-page business model
AI and automation	Practical AI tools for a small team	Three tasks automated or AI-assisted
GTM and customer acquisition	Choosing your first channel	A 30-day acquisition test plan
Pricing and unit economics	Pricing with confidence; knowing your margin	A pricing sheet and unit-cost model
Pitch readiness	The story investors and partners need	A 10-slide outline and practice feedback
Legal and operational foundations	Setup routes, contracts, compliance basics	A setup checklist and key contract list
Consumer-brand and retail	From product to shelf or online store	A channel plan and retailer pitch

A sample curriculum showing the format; no course catalogue exists yet.

Expert services — what founders typically need

Legal
Setup documents, shareholder agreements, contracts, IP basics

Accounting and finance
Bookkeeping, VAT registration, models, cash-flow planning

Branding and design
Identity, packaging, pitch design, website look and feel

Technology and automation
No-code builds, app scoping, workflow automation

Marketing and sales
Positioning, campaigns, sales scripts and CRM

Customer communication
WhatsApp and email journeys, support, reviews

Business setup
Licence route, free zone or mainland, banking, visas

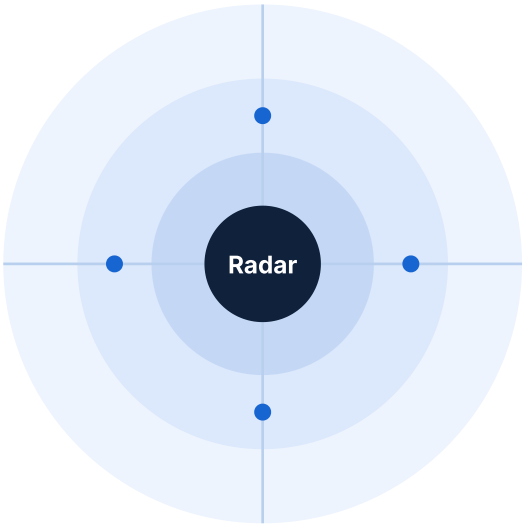
Product and retail guidance
Sourcing, manufacturing, listings, retail entry

Providers, packages and prices will be validated in the pilot; no supplier is confirmed.

INSIGHTS, MEDIA AND OPPORTUNITIES

What matters to a founder this week — with context.

Founders lose time searching for updates, events and calls for applications that may not apply to them. Startup Roof plans to curate what is relevant and explain why it matters.



Startup Roof Radar PLANNED

A curated view of startup updates, relevant events, and funding and programme opportunities — starting with the UAE and widening over time.

Founder interviews and media

Conversations with founders and practitioners that share practical lessons: what they tried, what worked and what they would do differently.

EDITORIAL PRINCIPLES

PRINCIPLE	WHAT IT MEANS IN PRACTICE
Relevance	Filtered by a founder's stage, sector and location.
Attribution	Every item credits and links to its original source.
Freshness	Items are dated and removed when no longer current.
Founder context	A short note on why it matters and what to do next.

UAE FIRST, GLOBAL AMBITION

Coverage will start with the UAE, where the project is based, and extend to other markets as the community grows. It will be selective and grow step by step — not a complete news service.

Selective, structured support — and better-prepared founders.

A proposed incubation pathway

Intensive support is selective. Places depend on fit, the founder's commitment and Startup Roof's delivery capacity, and terms are agreed separately with each business.

1. **Understand needs**
2. **Assess suitability**
3. **Define a support plan**
4. **Match mentors**
5. **Agree milestones**
6. **Review progress**

EXAMPLE PLAN	TECHNOLOGY STARTUP	CONSUMER OR SERVICE BUSINESS
Typical focus	Product–market fit, early traction, technical choices	Unit economics, channels, supply and operations
Example milestone	First ten paying customers on a defined plan	Margin-positive pilot with one retail or online channel
Typical specialists	Product, AI and automation, go-to-market	Brand, retail, sourcing, finance

Value for investors

Better founder preparation, more structured startup information shared with consent, relevant discovery by sector and stage, sector-specific sessions, more useful introductions and ongoing relationships with the ecosystem.

STARTUP ROOF AIMS TO	STARTUP ROOF DOES NOT
Help founders become investor-ready	Operate its own investment fund today
Make relevant, consented introductions	Promise deal flow, exclusivity or returns
Host sector sessions with investors	Assume every founder should raise capital

Any future investment activity would require its own structure, approvals and terms.

UNIVERSITIES, CORPORATES AND SERVICE PARTNERS

Practical ways to collaborate.

Continuity for student and alumni founders

Idea in class	University programme	Startup Roof	Alumni founder

WHAT UNIVERSITIES COULD GAIN	POSSIBLE FORMATS
Support after programmes end	Guest clinics and workshops
Practitioner mentors and specialists	Joint founder challenges
Visibility for student ventures	Mentor office hours on campus
Practical content for courses	Founder OS access for student founders

Corporates and service providers

PARTNER TYPE	CAN OFFER	CAN GAIN	STARTING FORMAT
Corporate innovation teams	Challenges, pilots, expertise	Early access to solutions and talent	A themed founder challenge
Professional firms	Legal, finance, tax, setup advice	Relationships with future clients	Monthly office hours
Technology providers	Tools, credits, technical guidance	Adoption by relevant founders	A limited tool pilot
Banks and financial institutions	SME banking, finance education	Better-prepared SME customers	A founder finance clinic
Venues and co-working	Space for sessions	Community activity and visibility	Hosting a founder evening
Media and content	Reach, interviews, editorial skill	Founder stories and insights	A co-created guide or series

Illustrative formats for discussion. No partnerships are signed or implied.

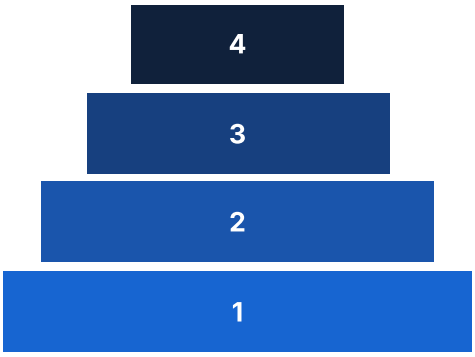
Free access can create reach. Useful services must create sustainable value.

Collaborating with ecosystem partners

Universities, incubators, corporates, professional firms and technology providers may take part to reach relevant founders, deliver education or specialist support, test services, support entrepreneurship programmes and explore commercial distribution.

- Workshops
- Office hours
- University programmes
- Tool or service pilots
- Community activities
- Content collaboration

These are possible formats to explore together; no partnerships are presented as signed.



Four layers of the proposed model PROPOSED

4 · Investment connections and future pathways — readiness and relevant introductions.

3 · Selective incubation — deeper support on separately agreed terms.

2 · Paid tools and support — deeper tools, specialist sessions, programmes.

1 · Free founder access — community, selected resources, discovery.

Revenue hypotheses to test

- Paid memberships or tools
- Specialist support packages
- Structured programmes
- Partner and service revenue arrangements
- Corporate or university programmes
- Sponsorship of suitable activities
- Selective incubation, where separately agreed

What the pilot must show

Free access builds reach and trust. Optional paid value must be clearly useful. Delivery costs — expert time, platform, events — are real. Each service's unit economics will be validated before any pricing or forecast is published.

Revenue to explore, test and scale — in order.

REVENUE HYPOTHESIS	NOW · SHAPE	NEXT · PILOT	THEN · EXPAND
Paid memberships or tools	Explore	Test	Scale
Specialist support packages	Explore	Test	Scale
Structured programmes	Explore	Test	Scale
Partner and service revenue	Explore	Explore	Test
Corporate or university programmes	Explore	Test	Test
Sponsorship of suitable activities	—	Explore	Test
Selective incubation arrangements	—	Explore	Test

"Scale" only after unit economics are proven. Sequencing will change with pilot evidence.

How each paid service must pay its way

Price paid by founder or partner − **Delivery cost** expert time, materials, venue − **Platform cost** tools, support, admin = **Contribution** sustains the free layer

QUESTIONS THE PILOT MUST ANSWER

- What will founders pay for, and how much?
- How much expert time does each outcome take?
- Which services work in groups to lower cost?
- Where do partners fund value for founders?
- What does free access cost per active founder?
- Which offers lead to repeat use?

No financial forecast is presented. Pricing will be tested before anything is published.

PROPOSED

A small, measured test of the founder experience.

Who	A small group of founders across stages and sectors, including non-tech businesses.
What	Onboarding, a validation or growth track, clinics, mentor sessions and follow-up.
How	Simple tools first; Founder OS features introduced as they are ready.
Contributors	Participants deliver sessions and support in roles that suit their time and skills.
Learning	Founder interviews, feedback after every session, delivery cost tracked throughout.

THE PILOT SUCCEEDS IF

- Founders complete useful next steps
- They return without being chased
- Sessions are rated as practical
- Contributors deliver reliably
- We know the real cost to serve

NORTH-STAR MEASURE

Completed founder next steps

Counts when the founder confirms it is done — usefulness, not activity.

Activation	New founders completing a profile and first step
Follow-through	Agreed actions completed after sessions
Return rate	Founders active again within 30 days
Useful introductions	Introductions leading to a real conversation
Session quality	Founder rating of practical value
Cost to serve	Delivery cost per active founder
Paid conversion	Founders choosing an optional paid service
Contributor reliability	Sessions delivered as committed

TRIAL AND ROADMAP

Shape, test, then expand what works.

Where we are: currently shaping the platform and testing the founder experience through an initial collaboration and pilot phase.

NOW

Shape and test

Founder interviews, participant contributions, service selection and platform requirements.

NEXT

Deliver a small pilot

Useful sessions, onboarding, follow-up, growth experiments and measurement of delivery costs.

THEN

Expand what works

Repeat strong services, improve the platform, formalise responsibilities and build partnerships.

MILESTONES WE ARE WORKING TOWARDS

10,000
free users

Threshold for a public launch event.

March 2027
tentative

Target timing, subject to readiness.

100,000
free users

Wider, longer-term ambition.

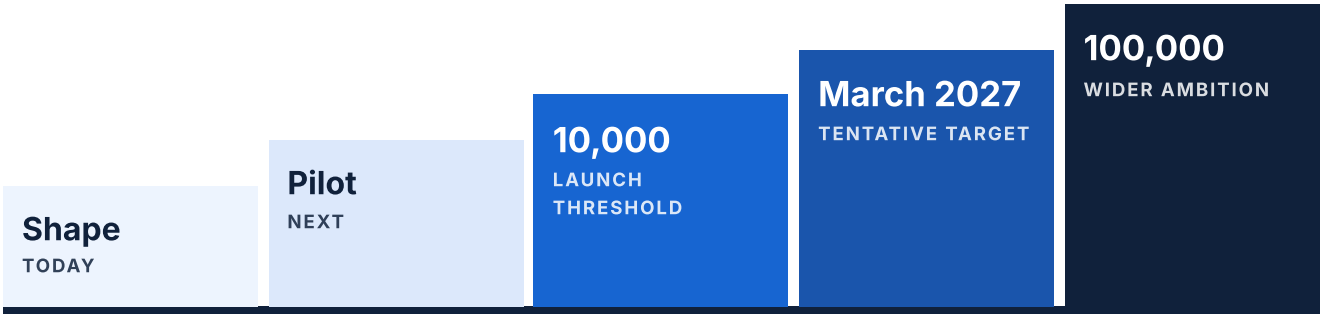
> **Targets and timing will be refined through the pilot.** These are ambitions and milestones, not current traction.

WHAT THE PILOT WILL HELP US LEARN

- Founder needs
- Useful services
- Platform requirements
- Partner opportunities
- Contribution models
- Delivery capacity
- Sustainable commercial models

TARGETS, NOT TRACTION

Each step must be earned by the one before it.



10,000 free users is the threshold for a public launch event; March 2027 is a tentative target subject to readiness; 100,000 free users is the wider ambition. All will be refined through the pilot. None represents current users or traction.

Risks and how we address them

RISK	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW WE ADDRESS IT
Low founder engagement	Without use, there is no ecosystem	Small pilot, practical formats, measure return rate
Inconsistent delivery	Volunteer time can be unreliable	Clear commitments; roles based on reliable delivery
Quality of advice	Poor advice harms founders and trust	Vetted contributors, founder ratings, human escalation
Cost to serve too high	Free access must be sustainable	Group formats; unit-economics test per service
Platform built too early	Wasted effort on unused features	Simple tools first; build what the pilot proves
Data and privacy	Founder trust is essential	Consent-first design; data-protection review
Over-promising	Credibility with founders and partners	Clear stage labels; no claims beyond evidence

PEOPLE AND COLLABORATION

Bringing complementary experience together.

We are exploring how like-minded contributors can participate through their experience, resources and available time. A group of interested participants is already helping to shape the concept.

STRATEGY AND COMMERCIAL

- Commercial leadership
- GTM and customer lifecycle
- Legal and governance

FOUNDER SUPPORT

- Startup and incubation experience
- Consumer-business mentoring
- Education and university outreach

PLATFORM AND GROWTH

- AI and business systems
- Branding and growth

COMMUNITY AND DELIVERY

- Operations and community
- Events and experiences

How roles will take shape

Everyone involved can contribute in a role that suits them. Longer-term roles and responsibilities will be considered as the project develops, based on:

- Actual contribution
- Time commitment
- Responsibility taken
- Reliable delivery
- Value created

WAYS TO CONTRIBUTE NOW

Join founder interviews · run a session · review platform ideas · introduce a relevant organisation · help plan the pilot.

Ritesh Kumar
Project Initiator

FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Short answers to common questions.

Is Startup Roof an accelerator or a fund?

Neither today. It is a founder ecosystem with a planned digital workspace. Any investment activity would need its own structure and approvals.

Do I need a tech startup to join?

No. Consumer, wellness, retail and service businesses are equally welcome.

Do I have to raise investment?

No. Many businesses grow from revenue; capital is one option among several.

How is my data used?

Consent first: founders control what is shared, and introductions need agreement from both sides.

How will longer-term roles be decided?

Later, based on actual contribution, time commitment, responsibility taken, reliable delivery and value created.

Is Founder OS live?

Not yet. It is planned and will be introduced step by step, starting in the pilot.

Will it cost money?

Founder access starts free. Optional paid tools and services will be tested in the pilot.

Is it only for the UAE?

It starts in the UAE, with an ambition to extend to other markets.

How can I contribute?

As a session lead, mentor, specialist, workstream contributor, connector or content contributor — in a role that suits your time.

How can I get involved?

Visit startuproof.com to express interest as a founder, mentor, partner, investor or contributor.

GLOSSARY AND SOURCES

Startup terms, explained.

Accelerator	A time-bound programme supporting startups, often with investment.
Angel investor	An individual investing personal money in early startups.
Bootstrapping	Funding a business from savings and revenue.
CAC	Cost of acquiring one new customer.
Churn	The rate at which customers stop buying.
Dilution	Owning a smaller share after new shares are issued.
Free zone	A UAE economic zone with its own licensing rules.
GTM	Go-to-market: how a product reaches customers.
Incubator	Support for very early ventures, often with space and mentoring.
LTV	Gross profit expected from a customer over time.
MVP	Minimum viable product — the simplest sellable version.
Pre-seed / Seed	Early funding rounds to build and find product–market fit.
Product–market fit	Strong, repeat demand from a clear market.
Runway	Months a business can operate on current cash.
Unit economics	Revenue and cost per unit, customer or order.
Venture capital	Professional funds investing in high-growth companies.

Sources for external data

1. CB Insights, “The Top 12 Reasons Startups Fail” (2021).
2. US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Business Employment Dynamics; “The Economics Daily” (2024).
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4. Endeavor Insight (2015) NYC founder research; “The Power of Entrepreneur Networks”.
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6. Wamda, annual MENA startup investment reviews, 2020–2025.
7. Global Entrepreneurship Monitor 2025/2026 Global Report and UAE country profile (2025).
8. UAE Ministry of Economy; Central Bank of the UAE; Minister of Economy (2023).
9. Dubai Media Office, Dubai Economic Agenda D33 (2023).
10. Startup Genome, Global Startup Ecosystem Report 2025.
11. OECD (2025), “Generative AI and the SME Workforce”; US Census Bureau, BTOS.

Figures are reported as published by each source and year. Startup Roof’s own targets are ambitions, not results.

INVITATION TO PARTICIPATE

Help shape a practical ecosystem for the founder journey.

Founders	Help shape the platform and express interest in the pilot.
Mentors and specialists	Contribute expertise and practical sessions.
Partners and universities	Explore a useful collaboration.
Investors	Connect around founder readiness and ecosystem opportunities.
Prospective collaborators	Discuss how your skills and time can contribute.

startuproof.com

Scan the code or visit the website to get in touch.

STARTUP ROOF

An ecosystem around the founder. A digital workspace for the journey.